

VIJO JOHN

Digital Finance & F&A Platforms · Banking & Financial Services · Enterprise AI Strategy

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India · Open to roles across Digital Finance, Banking & Capital Markets, and Enterprise AI Strategy

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Finance domain expert and hands-on AI builder. 15+ years across global financial services (State Street, HSBC, Ameriprise) — deep in **fund accounting & financial reporting for mutual funds, capital markets, and complex financial products** — now VP, Head of Finance, who also **builds AI products for digital finance hands-on** and runs the finance function that uses them. Pairs that domain depth with delivery of working **Agentic AI prototypes (LangGraph, RAG, evaluation harnesses)** across **accounts payable, order-to-cash (O2C), and record-to-report (R2R)** — the core F&A platform towers — plus controls and CFO decision-making. Owns AI-led digital-finance programs end-to-end: runs discovery with stakeholders, writes the PRD, picks the model, designs the eval, and builds the prototype — and is **currently learning Docker to containerize and deploy these prototypes**. IIM Kozhikode MBA (Strategy & Finance), Six Sigma Black Belt, ex-CISO with six consecutive years of zero material ITGC / SOC1 findings — rare combination of **product instinct, hands-on engineering, regulated-domain credibility, and governance rigor**.

SELECTED IMPACT

- **Built AI Finance OS** — an autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph agents (bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation) and CFO decision dashboards; scoped the MVP and built it end-to-end.
- **Shipped 6 finance & enterprise AI prototypes end-to-end** — NAV-break investigation & voice co-pilot, SOI review, timesheet intelligence — each with an offline eval harness (golden datasets, groundedness, LLM-as-judge).
- **Drove ~USD 200K annualized savings, +40% productivity, and -80% reporting-prep time** as Head of Finance, via process restructuring, vendor / SaaS optimization, and automation.

AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

Discovery & Definition	Problem framing for F&A platforms (AP / O2C / R2R) · user research with finance / ops stakeholders · jobs-to-be-done · PRDs · user stories · acceptance criteria
Roadmap & Prioritization	Use-case portfolio scoring · RICE / impact-effort · OKRs & KPI trees · release planning · stakeholder alignment across CFO / CTO / audit
LLM Product Patterns	Agentic workflows · RAG-grounded assistants · human-in-the-loop · prompt routing · cost / latency tradeoffs · fallback design · model selection (Azure OpenAI, Groq, Llama)
Evaluation & Quality	Offline evaluation harnesses · golden datasets · LLM-as-judge · groundedness & hallucination checks · prompt / model comparison · eval logging & telemetry

ENTERPRISE AI STRATEGY

Opportunity Portfolio	AI use-case discovery & qualification · value-at-stake sizing · ROI cases · sequencing under capacity constraints · CFO / board-ready business cases
Build vs Buy vs Partner	Vendor evaluation (Azure OpenAI, Qdrant, SaaS) · platform vs point-solution · vertical integration calls · TCO modeling
Operating Model	Center-of-excellence design · AI guild patterns · skills mapping · change management · adoption & enablement playbooks
Responsible AI & Governance	Human-in-the-loop controls · auditability · model risk · data privacy by design · enterprise AI policy · ISO 27001 / SOC1 alignment

AI & AGENTIC ENGINEERING — HANDS-ON

Agentic Orchestration	LangGraph multi-agent pipelines · supervisor / worker routing · reflection & revision loops · tool-using agents · stateful workflows · agentic memory
RAG & Retrieval	Qdrant vector DB · Sentence Transformers · multimodal RAG (CLIP) · PDF / document RAG · domain knowledge bases · semantic retrieval
LLMs & Evaluation	Azure OpenAI (enterprise) · Groq · Llama 3 · local / private LLMs · prompt routing · logging · evaluation harnesses
App Engineering	Python · FastAPI · Flask · Streamlit · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Pandas · API & service design · Docker containerization (learning)

ENTERPRISE DOMAIN DEPTH — FINANCE & CONTROLS

Finance Function	Accounts payable (AP / P2P) · order-to-cash (O2C) · record-to-report (R2R) · invoicing & billing ·
Ownership	AR, collections & DSO · reconciliations · month / quarter / annual close · MIS & leadership reporting
Compliance & Controls	GST · TDS · US GAAP & Ind AS · ITGC / SOC1 audit readiness · internal controls · governance frameworks · ISO 27001 · CISO experience
Systems & Tooling	advanced MS Excel & Power Query · ERP / accounting platforms · finance process automation

AI PRODUCTS — DESIGNED & BUILT HANDS-ON

AI Finance OS **FLAGSHIP** *Python · FastAPI · LangGraph · PostgreSQL · Streamlit*

Working prototype of an autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph-orchestrated agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, and reconciliation workflows, plus CFO decision dashboards. Owned the user journeys, scoped the MVP, chose the architecture, and built the system end-to-end.

NAV Break Investigation Agent *LangGraph · Azure OpenAI · Qdrant RAG*

Detection → Investigation → Reflection agent loop grounded by a RAG layer over NAV validation rules and investigation playbooks; prompt routing, logging, and an offline evaluation harness. Targets the real exception-management workflow fund accounting teams run every day.

NAV Break Voice Co-pilot *LiveKit voice / avatar · grounded tools · audit trail · guardrails*

Real-time voice / avatar co-pilot for the daily NAV-striking window — analysts query breaks hands-free (“walk me through break 4827, cite the source”) while watching the dashboard. Tool-grounded answers, full JSONL audit trail per token / tool / resolution, and a confirm-resolution guardrail; built on mock NAV records and designed to plug into the live NAV Break Investigation Agent.

SOI Review Agent *8-agent pipeline · PDF extraction · ASC 946 RAG · preventive controls*

Eight-agent pipeline automating Schedule of Investments review under US GAAP ASC 946 — PDF extraction, SOI detection, structured-data building, specialized validation, prior-cycle comparison, and a preventive-control agent grounded by an ASC 946 RAG knowledge base.

Timesheet Intelligence *Multi-agent · Groq · Llama 3 · risk scoring · tool use*

Data → Policy → Risk → LLM Insight → Reflection pipeline that surfaces only high-risk billing and utilization exceptions, with a project-effort calculator for risk-weighted prioritization.

Enterprise Ethics Advisor *Multimodal RAG · CLIP · fully local*

Fully local multimodal RAG for corporate ethics guidance; CLIP retrieves policy diagrams and text together — governed AI advisory with zero external data exposure. Built for regulated environments.

LEADERSHIP & TRANSFORMATION IMPACT

- **60+ clients migrated** to a new platform with 50% fewer support tickets.
 - **New US subsidiary incorporated** as a direct arm of the parent — simplified the operating model and enabled scalable cross-border operations.
- **Book closure BD10 → BD8** and MIS reporting accelerated by 2 days.
 - **CISO & ISO 27001 certified**; established SOC readiness through control-framework design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McLaren Strategic Solutions — Vice President, Head of Finance Jun 2025 – Present

- **Drive AI-led digital-finance transformation across F&A platforms as both strategist and builder** — defined the AI use-case portfolio, owned build-vs-buy calls, and personally built working agentic prototypes spanning accounts payable, order-to-cash, reconciliation, reporting, and controls.
- Run the finance function end-to-end as the design partner for the AI products — accounts payable (AP), order-to-cash (O2C), record-to-report (R2R), close, GST / TDS, US GAAP / Ind AS — across India and the US.
- Partner with senior leadership on AI strategy, governance, and roadmap; serve as bridge between business stakeholders, engineering, and audit.

State Street, Bangalore — Sr. AVP / AVP / Sr. Manager, Financial Reporting Jul 2018 – Jun 2025

Progressive growth: Sr. Manager (2018) → AVP (2020) → Senior AVP (2023)

- Built and led client-facing production teams delivering US GAAP-compliant financial statements and reconciliations on schedule, improving client satisfaction and retention.
- Oversaw ITGC and SOC1 audits with a record of **zero material findings**; accountable for reporting systems and data-feed integrity — direct relevance to enterprise AI governance and model risk.
- Managed post-M&A cross-functional integration (e.g., Syntel, HCL JVs); led P&L optimization and process re-engineering.

HSBC EDPI, Gurgaon — Manager, Business Finance**Dec 2016 – Jul 2018**

- Finance business partner for global operations — strategic insights, budgeting, forecasting, and CFO-level financial models.
- Engineered advanced data consolidation and reporting tools (Excel, Power Query), improving accuracy and timeliness across functions.

Ameriprise, Gurgaon — Trainer → Group Leader, Financial Reporting & Tax**Oct 2010 – Dec 2016**

- Grew from Fund Accounting trainer to Group Leader across financial reporting and tax, building deep accounting and reconciliation foundations.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA (EPGP), Strategy & Finance — Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Kozhikode · 2023**Certifications:** Six Sigma Black Belt · ISO 27001 Implementer · ISO 9001 Implementer · Leader as a Coach**Domains:** Capital Markets & Fund Administration · Banking · Insurance · IT — US GAAP & Indian Accounting (Ind AS)